Over 350,000 Palestinians fled from the West Bank when it was captured by the Israelis in 1967. Most of the refugees went to Jordan. In fact, from 1967, half the population of Jordan was Palestinian. Fatah and other groups within the PLO now concentrated their forces in Jordan and started to recruit far more volunteers from the refugee camps. Ghazi Daniel was one of many Palestinian refugees for whom 1967 was a turning point:

> The aggressive war of 1967 was a landmark in my life. The new expansion of Israel and the new waves of refugees multiplied the tragedy many times. This is why I have joined the Palestine Liberation Movement. We shall fight for the Palestinians' return.

Fatah increased its raids into Israel. Its guerrilla forces planted bombs and mines, and attacked military installations. In retaliation, in 1968, the Israelis crossed the border into Jordan and launched a full-scale attack on a major Fatah base in Karameh. The Israelis had 15,000 troops as well as tanks and planes. The Palestinians had 300 fighters. Although the Israelis destroyed the Palestinian base, the Palestinian forces, with the aid of Jordanian troops, knocked out several Israeli tanks and planes and killed 28 Israeli troops. They had proved that the Israelis were not invincible. This inspired thousands of Arabs, not just Palestinians, to join the Palestinian guerrillas: in fact, 5000 enlisted in the next two days. Between 1967 and 1970 Fatah forces killed over 500 Israelis. This was almost as many as the Israelis had lost in the whole Six-Day War.

Key dates

The 'Battle of Karameh': 1968

Arafat became Chairman of the PLO: 1969

Arafat becomes leader of the PLO

In 1968 the Palestinian fighters, led by Fatah, gained control of the PLO and, in 1969, Yasser Arafat, now internationally known as a result of the battle of Karameh, became Chairman. The new charter of the PLO proclaimed: 'Armed struggle is the only way to liberate Palestine'. Arafat tried to co-ordinate the guerrilla

Key question
Why did some Palestinian groups disagree with Arafat's methods?



Yasser Arafat was born in Jerusalem in 1929. He was one of the founders of the Fatah organisation and became chairman of the PLO in 1969. For reasons of security, he slept in a different bed every night.